
WORKSHEET

Where Should Your Business Actually Use AI?

Classify real opportunities as Automate, Assist, Analyze, Decide, or Don't Automate—then document the evidence behind the choice.

Pulse Analytics Group LLC

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The point of this worksheet is not to find the most places to use AI.

Start with the work your business already does. For each recurring task, identify what the task requires, what can go wrong, how much judgment it involves, and what happens if the output is wrong. Then classify the role AI could reasonably play.

The categories are intentionally practical. A task can move from one category to another as the technology, process, data, or risk changes.

The five classifications

AUTOMATE	The system can perform a defined step with limited human intervention and a clear exception path.
ASSIST	AI prepares, drafts, summarizes, suggests, or transforms work while a person remains responsible for the result.
ANALYZE	AI helps examine data, identify patterns, classify information, or surface questions; interpretation remains with a person.
DECIDE	A person uses AI as one input to a consequential decision. AI should not silently become the decision-maker.
DON'T AUTOMATE	The risk, ambiguity, data limitations, or human context make automation inappropriate for the current problem.

Business context

Business / team	_____
Person completing worksheet	_____
Date	_____
Primary business goal for this review	_____
Systems / tools in scope	_____

Step 1 — Inventory the work

List actual recurring tasks rather than broad departments. “Marketing” is too broad. “Draft the first version of a weekly email subject line” is specific enough to evaluate.

Task	Frequency	Current time/effort	Main input	Current pain point

Step 2 — Evaluate one opportunity at a time

Choose one task from the inventory and work through this page. Repeat the page for additional opportunities.

Opportunity	
What happens today?	
What would AI actually do?	
Who owns the result?	
What happens if it is wrong?	
What evidence would tell us it is working?	

Risk and judgment questions

- ☐ Does the task involve confidential, personal, financial, customer, employee, or proprietary information?
- ☐ Could a wrong output cause a customer-facing, financial, legal, reputational, employment, or safety problem?
- ☐ Does the task require context that is difficult to express as rules?
- ☐ Can a knowledgeable person reasonably verify the output before it matters?
- ☐ Is there a clear source of truth against which the output can be checked?
- ☐ Does the task have a stable definition of success?
- ☐ Will the workflow still make sense when inputs change or an unusual case appears?
- ☐ Can the process be stopped or reversed if something goes wrong?

Classification

	☐ DECIDE

Step 3 — Design the smallest useful AI role

You do not need to automate the whole task. Often the useful question is: “What is the smallest step AI can handle without taking away the judgment the business actually needs?”

Input	What information enters the workflow?	
AI action	Draft / summarize / classify / extract / compare / analyze / suggest / other	
Output	What exactly does the AI produce?	
Human review	Who reviews it, and against what criteria?	
Exception	What causes the workflow to stop or escalate?	
System of record	Where does the approved result live?	
Measurement	What will be measured after launch?	

Pilot plan

Pilot scope	_____
Baseline measure	_____
Target / acceptable range	_____
Sample size or review period	_____
Stop condition	_____
Person responsible	_____
Review date	_____

Decision record

What did you decide, and what evidence supports that decision?

Sources and further reading

- NIST AI Risk Management Framework: <https://www.nist.gov/itl/ai-risk-management-framework>
- NIST Generative AI Profile: <https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/ai/NIST.AI.600-1.pdf>
- FTC Advertising and Marketing Basics: <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/advertising-marketing>
- Google Search: AI-generated content guidance: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/using-gen-ai-content>